

EV FOR **VDA**



Enhance your expertise in the evolving world of electric vehicles and drive the future of automotive technology!



Scan the QR code to book now and get 10% off when you quote 'IAEA10'

Thatcham
Research
AUTOMOTIVE
ACADEMY

**IN
THIS
ISSUE**

- GROUNDBREAKING STAGED MOTORWAY PILE-UP
- AUDATEX X THE IAEA
- Q&A WITH VICTORIA WHITTLE, SOPP+SOPP
- AVIVA & DIRECT LINE MARKET SHARE

- LONDON REGION TOUR CATERHAM CARS
- ITAI CRASH DAY REPORT
- SINGLE USE VEHICLES?
- LATEST ENGINEERING ROLES

COUNCIL 2025

EXECUTIVE COUNCIL

e: executive@theiaea.org

PRESIDENT

D Punter M.Inst.A.E.A, MFIEA, MIO D, CAE M.I.M.I
e: david.punter@theiaea.org

PAST PRESIDENT (IMMEDIATE)

D Power F.Inst.A.E.A M.F.I.E.A. M.B.A.
e: darren.power@theiaea.org

PRESIDENT ELECT

P Briggs M.Inst.AEA, MFIEA, AAE, MIMI, FSOE FIRTE
e: phil.briggs@theiaea.org

FINANCE OFFICER

G Hunt Cert CII, F.Inst.AEA, MFIEA, CAE, MIMI, CertCII
e: finance.officer@theiaea.org

SECRETARY

Richard Warrington | e: secretary@theiaea.org

COUNCIL MEMBERS

Daniel Holloway M.Inst.A.E.A, MFIEA
e: daniel.holloway@theiaea.org

Victoria Whittle M.Inst.I.A.E.A, M.F.I.E.A, CAE, AMIMI
e: victoria.whittle@theiaea.org

Rick Stone M.Inst.A.E.A, CAE, FIEA, AMIMI
e: rick.stone@theiaea.org

M Wells M.Inst.A.E.A, MFIEA, MIRTE, IEng, MSOE
e: mark.wells@theiaea.org

C Aplin M.Inst.A.E.A, MFIEA, MIMI, AAE, MITRE, MSOE
e: chris.aplin@theiaea.org

M Taylor M.Inst.A.E, MFIEA e: matthew.taylor@theiaea.org

K Ashton e: karen.ashton@theiaea.org

Jason Russell M.Inst.A.E.A, MFIEA, CAE MIMI
e: jason.russell@theiaea.org

G Hunt Cert CII, F.Inst.AEA, MFIEA, CAE, MIMI, CertCII
e: finance.officer@theiaea.org

EDUCATION/MEMBERSHIP

M Wells M.Inst.A.E.A, MFIEA, MIRTE, IEng, MSO (Education officer)

Jason Russell M.Inst.A.E.A, MFIEA, CAE MIMI

Daniel Holloway M.Inst.A.E.A, MFIEA

EDUCATION COMMITTEE MEMBERS

Jason Russell M.Inst.A.E.A, MFIEA, CAE MIMI (Membership officer)

L Minton F.Inst.A.E.A, MFIEA, MIMI, AAE

C Jones F.Inst.A.E.A, MFIEA, MIMI, MIAATI

M Taylor M.Inst.A.E. MFIEA

Rick Stone M.Inst.A.E.A, CAE, FIEA, AMIMI

D Punter MIMI, M.Inst.A.E.A, MFIEA, MIO D

G Hunt Cert CII, F.Inst.AEA, MFIEA, CAE, MIMI, CertCII

PUBLIC RELATIONS OFFICER

P Briggs M.Inst.A.E.A, MFIEA, AAE, MIMI, FSOE FIRTE
e: phil.briggs@theiaea.org

FIEA REPRESENTATIVE

A Watling F.INST.A.E.A (Retired) AAE.MINI.MFIEA
e: info@theiaea.org

BENEVOLENT FUND e: benevolent.fund@theiaea.org

C Jones Chairman e: chris.jones@theiaea.org

D Ashall, A Russell, A Doughty Trustees

REGIONAL CHAIRMEN

BIRMINGHAM

Chris Jones

e: chris.jones@theiaea.org

BRISTOL

To be advised

IRELAND

Noel Maher

e: info@theiaea.org

LONDON

Gary Hunt

e: gary.hunt@theiaea.org

NORTH WEST

Darren Beirne

e: darren.beirne@theiaea.org

SCOTLAND

To be advised

SINGAPORE

KK Lau

LKK Auto Consultants

51, Ubi Ave 1, #02-25 Paya Ubi Industrial Park, Singapore 408933

t: +65 6841 2096 | e: sciaea@lkkauto.com

YORKSHIRE

Mark Wells

e: education.officer@theiaea.org

REGIONAL SECRETARIES

BIRMINGHAM

Mark Chandler

e: info@theiaea.org

BRISTOL

To be advised

IRELAND

Greg Byrne

e: info@theiaea.org

LONDON

Peter Beddow

e: info@theiaea.org

NORTH WEST

Karen Ashton

e: karen.ashton@theiaea.org

SCOTLAND

HP Doherty

e: info@theiaea.org

SINGAPORE

Tobiah Sia

51 Ubi Ave 1, 01-25 Paya Ubi Industrial Park, Singapore 408933

t: +65 6742 4178 | e: sciaea@lkkauto.com

YORKSHIRE

Mick Walker

e: info@theiaea.org

Copyright © 2025. The Institute of Automotive Engineer Assessors

DISCLAIMER

Neither the Institute, the editor or the Publishing Consultants are responsible for the opinions and statements of contributors. Opinions expressed are not those of the Institute unless specifically stated as such.

While every effort is made to ensure the accuracy of information in THE Assessors Journal, the publishers can accept no responsibility for errors or omissions, nor for claims made by the advertisers.

CONTENTS

NEWS

- 6 NEWS**
Updates from across the automotive claims industry.

MEMBERS

- 2 IAEA DIRECTORY**
IAEA Council Members, Committees and Regional contacts.
- 4 PRESIDENT'S COLUMN AND MEMBERSHIP NOTICEBOARD**
A welcome from IAEA President, David Punter.
- 16 THE IAEA COUNCIL MEMBER INTERVIEW**
A Q&A with IAEA Council Member, Victoria Whittle, who is Engineer Team Leader at sopp+sopp.
- 31 IAEA MEMBER BENEFITS: SOLERA AUDATEX AND CAPS**
Solera Audatex will be providing IAEA Members with access to the CAP valuation guides.
- 32 LONDON REGION MEETING REPORT**
The IAEA's London Region Honorary Secretary, Peter Beddow, reports from the recent tour of Caterham Car's impressive Dartford facility.

FEATURES

- 14 ITAI CRASH DAY**
The IAEA was well-represented at the ITAI Crash Test and Research Day in Derbyshire.
- 18 RACE TO THE BOTTOM FOR SINGLE USE VEHICLES?**
Massive changes vehicle manufacturers have undertaken may not be reflected in the world of vehicle valuations, writes Andrew Marsh.
- 20 MODERN INSURANCE MAGAZINE'S ASSOCIATIONS ASSEMBLE**
Views from the IAEA feature in Modern Insurance Magazine's "Associations Assemble" focus.
- 22 ENGINEERING ROLE ROUND-UP**
A look at some of the latest vacancies in the motor engineering sector.
- 24 RECALL CAMPAIGN – TAKATA AIRBAG**
Stellantis, the parent company of Citroën, has recalled tens of thousands of Citroën and DS models in the UK due to faulty airbags.
- 26 INSIDE THE WORLD'S BIGGEST CRASH TEST**
Cranfield University and Channel 4 stage a groundbreaking motorway pile-up.
- 28 ALLIANZ CONTINUES EXPANSION INTO THE UK**
An interview with Michael Golding, Allianz Motor Network Manager and Jessica Archbold, Allianz Network Delivery Manager.
- 30 INSURANCE M&A ACTIVITY HOTS UP**
An update on the top ten motor insurers in the UK after Aviva and Direct Line's £3.7 billion "mega-merger" deal.
- 35 DIARY DATES**
Key industry events.



PRESIDENT'S COLUMN

Welcome to the latest edition of The Assessors Journal, which will be my last contribution as President.

From 20 September 2025, I will be moving into the role of Immediate Past President, as Philip Briggs takes the helm as the new President for the next two years.

On reflection on my time as President over the last two years, it has been a pleasure to support the Institute, and we have seen much change and stability come from Council in the form of supporting the ABI over the Code of Practice for the Categorisation of Motorised Vehicle Salvage and our recommitment to our Affiliation with the British Engineering Council by strict audit, to name a couple of key projects.

We are still working on new CPD content going forward, the regeneration of the regions, and also our continued growth into the sector as it looks more to us for guidance and reference as technical challenges begin to grow due to the complexities of vehicle construction.

The PR team now have all of the feedback in from our Member surveys, and will be acting on this, and getting in touch if you made representation to assist us in any way.

We look forward to seeing as many of you as possible for our AGM on Saturday 20 September 2025 at Stonebridge Golf Club, Somers Rd, Meriden, Coventry CV7 7PL at 11:30am, or online via the invitation instructions. But, for now, enjoy this edition and let's support the incoming President to continue to raise our profile, profession and, indeed, our Member skills.

David Punter | President | IAEA



MEMBERSHIP NOTICEBOARD



MEMBERSHIP UPDATE

Hi all,

I'm Soraya and I will be your new point of contact at the IAEA. I had been supporting the previous Administrator, Alyson, over the past two years with general duties but have now taken over the role fully. I look forward to getting to know everyone!

Soraya Ahmed, IAEA Administration

Email: info@theiaea.org

Tel: 01296 642895

ONLINE SHOP

The IAEA SHOP can be found on our website www.iaea-online.org

Click on the IAEA SHOP tab and choose the relevant dropdown under FEES AND APPLICATIONS.

POST-NOMINALS

Again, we remind members of the correct format of postnominals:

- **Fellows:**
F.Inst.A.E.A
- **Honorary Fellows:**
Hon.F.Inst.A.E.A
- **Members:**
M.Inst.A.E.A
- **Associates:**
A.Inst.A.E.A
- **Affiliates:**

Please remember that Affiliates are not entitled to use post-nominals. If you have queries about the institute, please contact head office.

CIRCULATION OF
1400
AUTOMOTIVE
ASSESSORS

REACH
YOUR
TARGET
MARKET

ADVERTISING
RATES

FULL COLOUR	GENERAL RATES
FRONT COVER	£1000
REAR COVER	£900
INSIDE FULL PAGE	£800
INSIDE HALF PAGE	£500

INTERESTED?

To advertise please contact Felicity Dowling on **07534 385 091** or email **felicity@abpclub.com**



iaea
THE INSTITUTE OF AUTOMOTIVE
ENGINEER ASSESSORS

MEMBERSHIP NEWS

IAEA ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING 2025

We are pleased to advise that the AGM this year will be held as a physical event at the Stonebridge Golf Club with the option for a remote dial in.

A notice will be sent out in due course to Corporate Members confirming that the AGM will take place on 20 September 2024 at Stonebridge Golf Club, Somers Road, Meriden, Coventry CV7 7PL at 11:30am

Can I attend the AGM if I am not a Corporate Member?

All Members of the Institute are invited to attend the AGM, but only Corporate Members are permitted to vote.

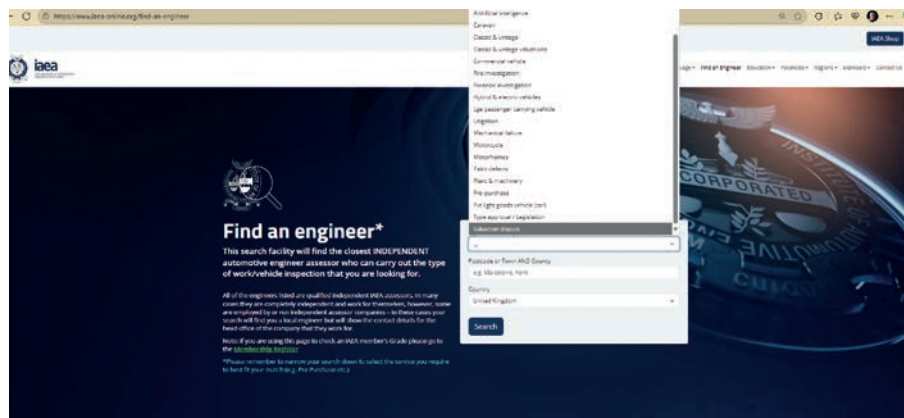
We ask that any questions you wish to be raised at the AGM are submitted ahead of the event, either on the registration form or by email to the company secretary.

If you wish to attend in person, then we will reach out via email before the event to advise how to do this or, Book online Teams AGM attendance via invitation (if you have not had this, please contact info@theiaea.org to arrange).

Download AGM 2025 Agenda (coming soon) via:
<https://www.iaea-online.org/members/agm>

FIND AN ENGINEER

PLEASE CHECK AND UPDATE



We will shortly be updating the "find an engineer" function on the IAEA's website.

Please could Members log onto their access and review what they cover and where they cover so we can ensure we always give the best service to the public.

If we can draw your attention to the new categories we have added as Type approve / Litigation and valuation dispute. If you wish to be included you will need to update your settings in the website – please see the image screenshot for help.

IAEA MEMBERSHIP BENEFITS



iaea
THE INSTITUTE OF AUTOMOTIVE
ENGINEER ASSESSORS



Solera Audatex is providing IAEA Members with access to the CAP valuation guides (three in total) so the IAEA candidates can use the guide which they are familiar with during their practical examinations for valuing vehicles. The IAEA would like to thank the team for kindly supporting our Members through their training – look out for more details in the next issue of The Assessors Journal.



IAEA
REGIONS

There are currently eight areas where regular regional meetings and activities take place:

1. Birmingham
2. Bristol
3. Ireland
4. London
5. North West
6. Scotland
7. Yorkshire
8. Singapore

Regional meetings are an excellent opportunity for current and potential members, and their business colleagues and acquaintances, to network and hear speakers talk about the latest industry issues.

Your region may also organise trips to motor trade venues to encourage networking and learning opportunities.

All regional lectures count towards CPD (continuous professional development).

Many regions also hold social events such as annual dinners, golf days and BBQs etc which are great for networking and socialising with fellow colleagues in the industry, although these are not CPD events.

If you would like to set up a new region in your area, the Council would be delighted to hear from you and help to get things going. Contact us by phone:
01296 642895

POWERED BY THE IAEA-BODYSHOP THATCHAM VEHICLE DAMAGE ASSESSOR OF THE YEAR



Thatcham Research to host assessments for Bodyshop Magazine Awards, championing industry talent. Pictured are the trainers and assessors, Scott Loran, Philip Wilkes, Graham Keep, David Alder, Kieron Woolgar.

For the first time, Thatcham Research's Automotive Academy hosted all the practical assessments for the awards from Monday 28 to Wednesday 30 July, providing the opportunity for skilled technicians to showcase their expertise across a range of automotive repair disciplines.

The partnership reflects Thatcham Research's commitment to driving innovation, shaping industry standards, and highlighting the critical role of efficient vehicle damage assessment and repair in enabling sustainable motoring and keeping total cost of ownership affordable for drivers.

The disciplines to be assessed will include:

- Powered by asTech-Bodyshop Thatcham Advanced Technologies Technician of the Year
- Powered by the IAEA-Bodyshop Thatcham Vehicle Damage Assessor of the Year
- Powered by Vizion-Bodyshop Thatcham Paint and Panel Technicians of the Year

Three separate apprentice categories will celebrate the young talent found in our industry including:

- Powered by Vizion-Bodyshop Thatcham Paint and Panel Apprentices of the Year

IN MEMORY OF DAVID FRIEND

The IAEA was saddened to hear about the loss of a retired member of the Institute, David Friend. David was known to many repairers in and around the West Midlands and Staffordshire. The message from his family was received just as this issue went to print. David was a great colleague and friend, and I'm sure that he has many friends amongst engineers based in his areas.

His family writes:

"It is with a broken heart this message is being written. Our beloved partner, dad and grandad, the legend that is Dave Friend sadly passed away on Monday 28 July. His funeral is going to be held on Monday 8 September at 4:10pm at Gornal Wood Crematorium. We can't explain the pain and loss we feel at this time but he will never be forgotten and always loved."

POSTNOMS IMPORTANT INFORMATION

Andrew Patterson, Motor Engineer / Director at Collision Engineers, is "calling out fake post-nominals in our industry".

Andrew writes: "Too often, we see individuals adding letters after their name that aren't real qualifications – hoping to impress insurers, clients, or even the courts.

"I understand there is a serious shortage of good, qualified Engineers, but employers sending anyone with a pulse, an iPhone, and some blag quals to inspect a vehicle is not the way forward.

"These bogus titles dilute the genuine, hard-earned qualifications.

"Many of us have studied late into the night, worked weekends, and balanced family life to earn the proper accreditations – the right way.

"When I speak out against rogue reports and unqualified assessors, it's not just for me – it's for every honest professional who's done the work."

IAEA RESPONSE

The IAEA's President, David Punter, said:

"I agree completely with this sentiment and would urge anyone finding any "engineer" using any post nominals which include IAEA in them outside of our recognised prescribed set to get in touch with the IAEA at admin@theiaea.org.

"All too often we see IAEA AQP and would reiterate that AQP, IMI VDA etc are certifications and not post nominals.

"On the subject of the IMI (and I have been with them since 1994), I recently took them to task on an "engineer" using Aff.I.M.I. On his report as his only post nominals, citing this was dangerous and irresponsible in the use of modern vehicle repair standards.

"What made this even worse was the response that the individual was not even a member anymore!

"So we the IAEA agree with this and are working in the background to highlight this misdemeanour."

Please read the note on page 4 of this issue re POST-NOMINALS.

[continued on page 8]

CRASH FOR CASH IS THE MOST RECOGNISED SCAM ACCORDING TO AGEAS SURVEY



Research commissioned by Ageas UK reveals more than one in 10 people are completely unaware of insurance scams like Crash for Cash and Ghost Broking. This overall lack of awareness is greatest among 18-24 year-olds, with almost one in five reporting they had no knowledge of any insurance scams.

Among all respondents, Crash for Cash is the most recognised scam with more than one in four of those surveyed reporting that they were aware of this fraudulent activity.

Katie Davies, Director of Underwriting Services and Fraud at Ageas UK, said there are "35 known organised Crash for Cash gangs currently under surveillance by Ageas" and it is "clear that this remains an ongoing challenge."



AVERAGE EV INSURANCE PREMIUM NOW £1,344

There has been a sharp rise in electric vehicle (EV) insurance premiums, driven by higher repair costs, labour expenses, and parts shortages – factors that often lead to unsustainable write-offs after minor accidents, according to a recent white paper by FWD Research.

The paper draws on insights from a survey of 250 insurance brokers across the UK and was released shortly after the UK government announced a £1 billion investment in EV infrastructure and introduced new incentives to support EV adoption.

According to the study, the average EV insurance premium now stands at £1,344 – nearly double that of traditional petrol and diesel vehicles.

A lack of a robust parts and repair ecosystem for EVs is inflating costs and often leads insurers to write off vehicles after minor accidents. 90% of brokers surveyed view this practice as economically and environmentally unsustainable.

ISO9001 LEAD AUDITOR ACCREDITATION SUCCESS FOR ITAS



ITAS's Manufacturer Network Development Manager David Harvey and Lead Auditor Philip Briggs have completed ISO9001 Lead Auditor accreditation.

"This qualification is certified and approved by the global quality standards body, the CQI and IRCA and is a vital component of the auditing services we offer to our manufacturer partners underscoring the significance we attribute to upholding compliance across our managed networks," said ITAS.

AVERAGE UK PREMIUM NOW STANDS AT £757

The average UK premium now stands at £757, having fallen by 16% (£144) in the last 12 months, according to the latest Confused.com/WTW report. This is the biggest annual percentage cut since 2014.

The ongoing trend of falling car insurance prices has meant premiums have been gradually dropping for almost 18 months across the board.

Average premiums peaked at £995 in December 2023.



**RECLAIMED OE PARTS AT A FRACTION OF
NEW OE PRICES**

- * Quality assured
- * Supplied by independently-certified UK recyclers
 - * Accurately & consistently graded
 - * Full audit trail from donor vehicle
 - * Prompt delivery
 - * BS10125-compliant
- * 12 month warranty on all body parts

Find out more here: www.vrac.org.uk

MERCEDES SEE 49% INCREASE IN MERCEDES-BENZ COUNTERFEIT PRODUCTS IN 2024



In 2024 alone, authorities secured more than 1.5 million Mercedes-Benz counterfeit products in 793 raids and with the help of customs worldwide – an upward trend.

There was a 49% increase in 2024: with more than 212,000 counterfeit product listings removed from social media and online platforms. This included 793 raids: globally, more than two raids daily conducted by trade supervisory and law enforcement agencies targeting Mercedes-Benz counterfeits.

CARS WITH ADAS COST 40% MORE TO REPAIR



Research in the US that suggests that the cost of repairing cars with ADAS features is around 40% higher than cars without these features, with variation based on type of collision and ADAS equipment damaged (for example, a 70% increase for side mirror repairs and 25% for windscreen replacement). Will Chamberlain, Principal at LEK Consulting, says "ADAS reduces collisions and claims rates, but increases average repair cost" and "this is reshaping motor insurance and vehicle repairs."

INTERNATIONAL SCALE OF THE UK'S STOLEN VEHICLE PROBLEM



Thatcham Research has joined forces with the National Vehicle Crime Intelligence Service (NaVCIS) on a new investigation which reveals the international scale of the UK's stolen vehicle problem.

Despite the UK having the highest levels of on-vehicle security in the world, a vehicle was stolen every five minutes in 2024. In terms of standard features and optional extras, vehicles from the UK are often better equipped than those from other markets, making them a target for international criminal gangs.

Uncovering the major routes and countries used by organised criminal gangs to export a wide variety of luxury cars, SUVs and pickups, Thatcham Research's new data also reveals the reasons why vehicles stolen in the UK are being exported to countries around the world. 52% of the vehicles intercepted by NaVCIS were from premium and luxury manufacturers and 79% of all interceptions were SUVs, showing a strong appetite for this class of vehicle for usage and parts.

The top five countries identified for stolen vehicle export by Thatcham Research and NAVCIS's new data (2021-2024) are the Democratic Republic of Congo (38.5%), UAE (20.1%), Cyprus (6.7%), Jamaica (5.7%) and Georgia (5.1%). This illegal export market is driven by factors as wide ranging as the scarcity of vehicle parts, desirability of certain makes and models, geopolitical events and even natural disasters.

[continued on page 12]



KiNETiC'25

CONFERENCE | EXHIBITION | NETWORKING



The collision industry's biggest event has officially reached full capacity!

Kinetic'25, the Repair Industry's most anticipated event, has officially reached full capacity, smashing all previous attendance records

With 1467 leaders, innovators, and decision-makers from across the industry attending, this year's event is on track to be the biggest and most impactful yet.

Missed out?

Join the cancellation waitlist now and don't miss your chance to be part of the industry's flagship event.

03.09.25 - 04.09.25

Telford International Centre

International Way, Telford, Shropshire UK TF3 4JH

www.kinetic25.com

Diamond Partners



Platinum Partners



Collective Partners



Gold Partners



Media Partners



CAR CANNIBALISM



Autocar says the high cost of new parts and easy online resale is fuelling increase in crime.

Admiral Insurance says thefts of car parking sensors have risen by 300% amid an increase in overall vehicle parts crime across the country as last year it recorded 142 claims for stolen parking sensors, compared with 36 claims the previous year.

They also had an additional 104 claims for stolen steering wheels and airbags.

The Midlands appears to be suffering the worst with what is known as '**car cannibalism**', said Autocar.

PAINT-FREE VEHICLE BODY PANELS FROM TESLA



Tesla has filed a patent for "method of manufacturing paint-free vehicle body panels". The painting step is eliminated from the production workflow, reducing manufacturing complexity and production cycle time in comparison to existing techniques."

VP Lars Moravy explained: "You inject the polyurethane paint at the same time that you make the plastic panels. There's no paint shop with that vehicle. We put the colors in when we make the panels. That's it. If you want to repair it, it's just basically paint."

This new process will mean they don't have to paint the Cybercab when it goes into production.

HASTINGS



David Carter has been promoted to 'Managing Director Retail Operations' at Hastings Direct – the UK's 5th largest motor insurer.

David joined Hastings in 2013 and had been Claims Operations Director since May 2022.

TESCO



Craig Bundell has been appointed as Chief Executive Officer of Tesco Insurance and Money Services. He has been interim CEO since February 2025 having joined Tesco Bank in January 2023. Previously, Craig was Motor Director – Commercial, Digital and Marketing at Hastings for two years.

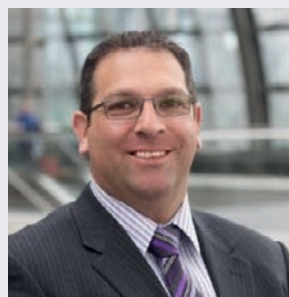
ERS



ERS has promoted Chris Wilson as Head of Fleet and Commercial Motor, following Scott Tillbrook's promotion to Active Underwriter.

This strategic move brings two closely aligned classes under single leadership, adding Commercial motor responsibility to Chris's previous Head of Fleet role. He joined ERS in 2014.

VOLKSWAGEN



Volkswagen Group (VWG)UK has promoted Franco Iannotta to the role of Insurance Ratings & Technical Projects Manager. Franco was previously Bodyshop Development Manager and has been with VWG for 27 years.



BORDERLINE

BMW/MINI Proactive Borderline provides an integrated connection between BMW and connected UK bodyshops. The Proactive Borderline technology can identify if a vehicle is a potential borderline total loss, so you don't have to. The Borderline Team will look to provide additional parts support to help minimise vehicles becoming a total loss.

**To get your bodyshop connected to the new proactive programme please contact 01484 318571
application@bmwborderline.co.uk**

**BMW/MINI Proactive Borderline
BMW Service with Proactive Care
There before you need us.**

#stayahead





FORENSIC COLLISION INVESTIGATION RESEARCH DAY

The IAEA was well-represented at the ITAI Crash Test and Research Day in Derbyshire, a popular and action-packed research day for forensic collision investigators and industry professionals – helped by a generous dose of British sunshine!

The annual day is organised by the Institute of Traffic Accident Investigators (ITAI).

IAEA Council Members, Mark Wells and Jason Russell, manned the IAEA stand in the exhibition area, joined by President Elect, Phil Briggs, and enjoyed catching up with several fellow Members and talking to the wide range of attendees about the IAEA's activities.

This year's event was presented in conjunction with Passive Safety UK and attended by members of the emergency services, insurers and engineers, vehicle examiners, highway management experts, incident scene mapping and vehicle data capture specialists, and suppliers of forensic equipment for vehicle and system testing, to gain a better understanding of crash dynamics.

Throughout the day the ITAI team run a series of staged collisions and a programme of lectures, alongside an exhibition of road safety equipment and tech companies.

IMPACTS

The most dramatic of the eight planned staged incidents on the main track saw a Peugeot 207 travelling at 54mph hit a communications cabinet in the 'non-passive communications cabinet' test. Spectators then observe the resulting vehicle damage, including intrusion into the passenger cabinet, as well as the spread of vehicle debris created from such an impact. For comparison, the same test was also run with a car impacting a passively safe comms cabinet which sheared off without transferring unacceptable deceleration forces on the vehicle occupants.

Other crash tests included different potential damage (vehicle and occupants) in a saloon car hitting a traditional steel post versus a hydro aluminium post, a 50mph T-bone, and a car hitting a HGV in the 'truck under run' test.

All vehicles are fitted with telematics and event data recorders.

There were lectures on advanced safety road signs and forensic collision investigation technique, accident video analysis and deepfake detection software.

IAEA SUPPORT

Mark Wells, Education Officer for the IAEA, said:

"It was a great day to actively witness what happens in an accident, but valuable to network with not just other motor engineers, but others who our

profession interfaces with, as well as those who could use our professional services. We had some really positive engagement and genuine interest on what our members and institute offer."

"I had a great day as did the nine or so of my colleagues from LV= / Allianz insurance that came along too," said Jason Russell, IAEA Membership Officer and LV= GI Engineer. "It was nice speaking with some people who used to be members that were looking to come back into the IAEA, but also some members that were happy to see us there."

"I really enjoyed driving the Volvo FH truck – that was probably my highlight," said Jason who added that the final two impacts were "very eye opening".

LIGHTS, CAMERAS ACTION!

Camera such as the i-SPEED 5 Series from iX Cameras capture "every fragment, bounce, and twist" at 3,000 frames per second. The ITAI Crash Day 2025 footage revealed violent fragmentation and high-velocity debris, rear-view dynamics of the impact, vehicle launch trajectory and multiple rebounds and airborne motion following the collision.

Standby UK supplied and installed advanced Telematics equipment on the collision vehicles which provided critical insights into vehicle performance and movement, supporting accurate accident reconstruction and deeper contextual understanding.

"The ITAI Annual Crash Day continues to be a cornerstone event for professionals focused on traffic accident investigation, and 2025 was no exception," said Standby UK. "It provided a vital platform to showcase new technologies and techniques aimed at improving investigation accuracy and road safety outcomes."



"Our involvement in ITAI 2025 is more than just a technological contribution, it's a reflection of the value we place in risk reduction and proactive support for the traffic investigation community. By providing both innovative hardware and the expertise of our team, Standby UK continues to enable investigators to carry out their work with greater precision and confidence."

PASSIVE SAFETY

Exhibitors included passively safe products and other safety related products and services, such as BlinLight and KerbedIT and the low level LATTIX Gantry had installed on the track. This assembly was set up to support pedestrian dummies to be used for some of the crashes. "Full height versions of this gantry are commonly used across Scandinavia to support overhead traffic signs and signals," explained Passive Safety UK.

THE PASSIVE SAFETY UK CRASH AND LECTURE PROGRAMME

Crash 1: A passively safe high-capacity aluminium post: manufactured by Hydro Pole Products UK: impacting a saloon car into the right-hand post of this eight-metre high sign assembly. Despite its strength and ability to help hold up the large sign,

the post will break away upon impact, without transferring unacceptable deceleration forces upon the vehicle occupants. A subsequent lecture on the design of these posts was presented by Ian McDonald of Hydro.

Crash 3: A passively safe signals/communications cabinet: impacting a saloon car into this item, which will shear off without transferring unacceptable deceleration forces upon the vehicle occupants. A subsequent lecture on the development of this cabinet was presented by Ben Ritherdon of Ritherdon & Co.

Crash 5: A traditional, non-passively safe signals/communications cabinet. For comparison, there was also a test impacting a saloon car into a traditional alternative to the previous cabinet, so that the difference in relation to vehicle behaviour, deceleration and potential intrusion into the passenger compartment can be observed.

Crash 9: A steel non-passive 168mm diameter Circular Hollow Section (CHS). For comparison with the earlier crash into the hydro aluminium HCP post, a test impacting a saloon car into a traditional steel post was conducted, so that the difference in relation to vehicle behaviour, deceleration and potential intrusion into the passenger compartment and subsequent injuries could be observed.

Crash 11: A test impacting a saloon car into the rear of an HGV, intended to simulate a stopped works vehicle, with the intention of showing the unacceptable deceleration forces transferred to the vehicle occupants in such a collision. "The importance of using vehicle mounted attenuators, or crash cushions, cannot be overstated," said the Passive Safety UK team. "These can prevent the likelihood of serious injury, both to the occupants of the impacting vehicle and to the roadworkers inside the works vehicle."





VICTORIA WHITTLE, SOPP+SOPP ENGINEER TEAM LEADER AND IAEA COUNCIL MEMBER

IAEA Council Member, Victoria Whittle, Engineer Team Leader at sopp+sopp, is an experienced motor insurance industry specialist, holding roles at Allianz and RBS. Victoria spoke to The Assessors Journal about her career to date, her involvement with the IAEA (including as the first female Chairperson, for the Bristol Region), and her love for classic cars!



Q: WHAT ARE SOME OF THE MAJOR CHANGES YOU HAVE SEEN IN THE INDUSTRY AND HOW HAVE YOU AND YOUR TEAM ADAPTED TO THOSE CHANGES?

If I went into all the changes over the years, it might not be the best thing to do as I could give away my age. The obvious ones are the transition to electric vehicles and, most recently, the ABI Code of Practice.

To adapt to any change, it is all about knowledge and investigation / research. Having the common sense to be able to ask if you are not sure and not to make any uninformed decisions. My team and I have a great working relationship whereby we discuss anything that requires confirmation or a second opinion or expertise in that area, it can be anything. Knowing your own limitations, we may think we are the font of all knowledge, but in reality...

Q: WHAT ARE THE KEY ISSUES FACING MOTOR ENGINEERS IN 2025?

So, I asked around for this question because my team are on the ground – doing the do. Having manufacturers' information for new vehicles is still lacking, when dealing with damaged vehicles it is paramount to know details to ensure the correct repair method is being used.

Technical information can be difficult to obtain which pushes a customer into a dealer repair scenario. Food for thought will be the introduction of the hydrogen vehicle, a "watch this space" situation.

Q: WHAT INFLUENCED YOUR DECISION TO JOIN THE IAEA COUNCIL?

I have been on – and off-Council for many years in the past: when Phil Archer was President, Adam Murray and sat alongside Alan Doughty, Les Minton and many other esteemed gentlemen. So, when the opportunity arose to work alongside David Punter, Rick Stone, Matthew Taylor and Alan Watling again, seeing the direction the IAEA was going – I felt I could contribute to its end goal.

No one was more surprised than me when I received confirmation that I had indeed been elected. That's something else that I believe sets the IAEA in high regard: you are voted into Council and not just selected. Others have faith in you, too, to help make the right decisions.

My previous posts for Council have been, Education, and General Council,



I've been the Secretary and then President, for the Bristol region, too, for many years.

Q: WHAT VALUE CAN THE IAEA BRING TO ITS MEMBERS?

It offers prestige, support, training, advice and guidance. Being a Member should make you feel proud to be part of an outstanding organisation, it reinforces your accountability, ethics and morals.

The Institute is there for all Members to utilise, each Engineer's needs will be different – if you are unable to find your answer, you can just ask.

I am an advocate for the IAEA and always have been, always will, some may say I am bias, I have no reason not to be. As a result, I recommend the IAEA to all Engineers I encounter.

Q: FINALLY, OUTSIDE WORK WHAT DO I ENJOY?

You mean apart from being the IAEA cheerleader! I love (believe it or not) classic cars. I love the smell inside and out. I love the smiles you bring to many people's faces and can't get enough of just driving them.

I also enjoy helping my husband restore our house. I'm pretty run of the mill really: the gym, occasionally reading.

Currently, I'm enjoying the prospect of early retirement – will it come to fruition – think that's the million-dollar question.

Thanks for reaching out! 



RACE TO THE BOTTOM FOR SINGLE USE VEHICLES?

Massive changes vehicle manufacturers have undertaken may not be reflected in the world of vehicle valuations. Unchecked, this could cause immense damage to insurers, assessors and the collision repair business, writes Andrew Marsh, FIMI, Hon member of IAEA.



In one part of the automotive market pricing remains very sensitive – namely battery electric vehicles ('BEV'). Compared with other powertrains, these remain at a price disadvantage primarily due to prevailing Li-Ion battery technology, the single most expensive sub-assembly, compared to internal combustion engine ('ICE') or electrified ICE powertrains. While older Li-Ion battery technologies have fallen in cost, newer, more energy dense systems command higher prices – countering price reductions.

The BEV market is very sensitive to rebates or tax incentives, which has in turn played havoc with residual values. It could be said many BEVs, even with known defects, have been undervalued. Another reboot was required....

Which leads to the present 'cunning plan' from Baldrick: Aim to sell BEVs at around £30000 or less. Within the EU27 the magic number is under €20000. This should boost volume and increase rate of adaption, disregarding where the electricity comes from....

STARK REALITY

2025 has been a very interesting year.

The European manufacturers knew they could price match by stripping the lowest cost product back, while the EU27 Commission imposed additional 10% tariffs on all China built BEVs – with some moderation for companies that 'co-operated'.

We learnt that Chinese vehicle manufacturers can take an additional 10% import tariff and remain profitable. European manufacturers quickly saw that this confirmed their suspicions,

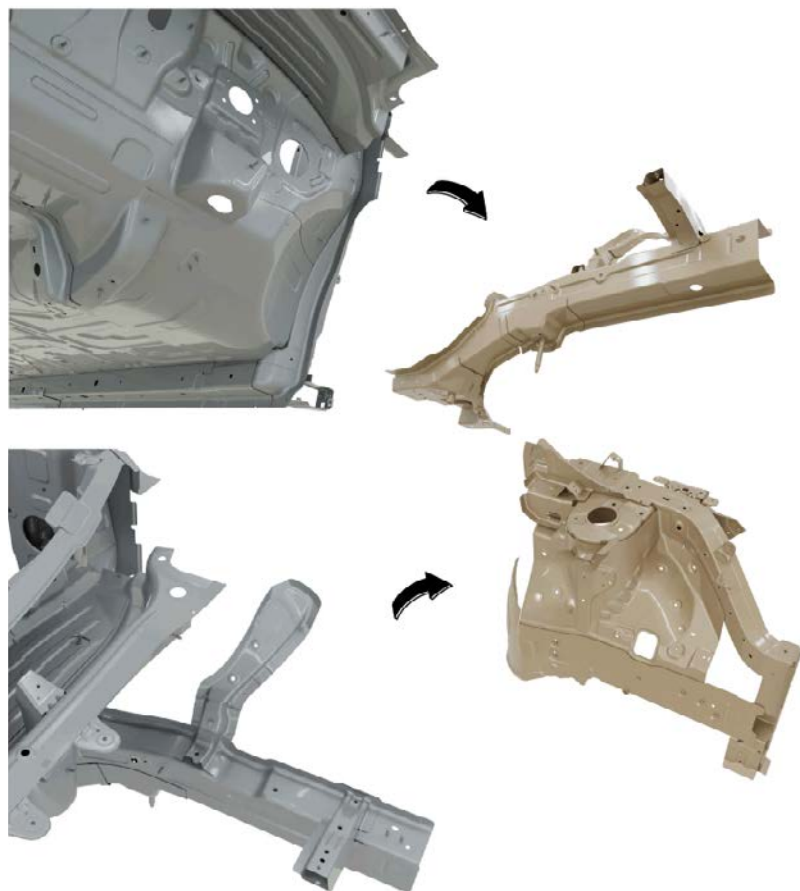
and could apply to all vehicle market segments.

BEV STRUCTURAL QUIRKS

BEVs do not need front chassis legs of the type typically used when an internal combustion engine is present. Even if the BEV has a front drive motor, the impact intrusion is far easier to manage. The following images are

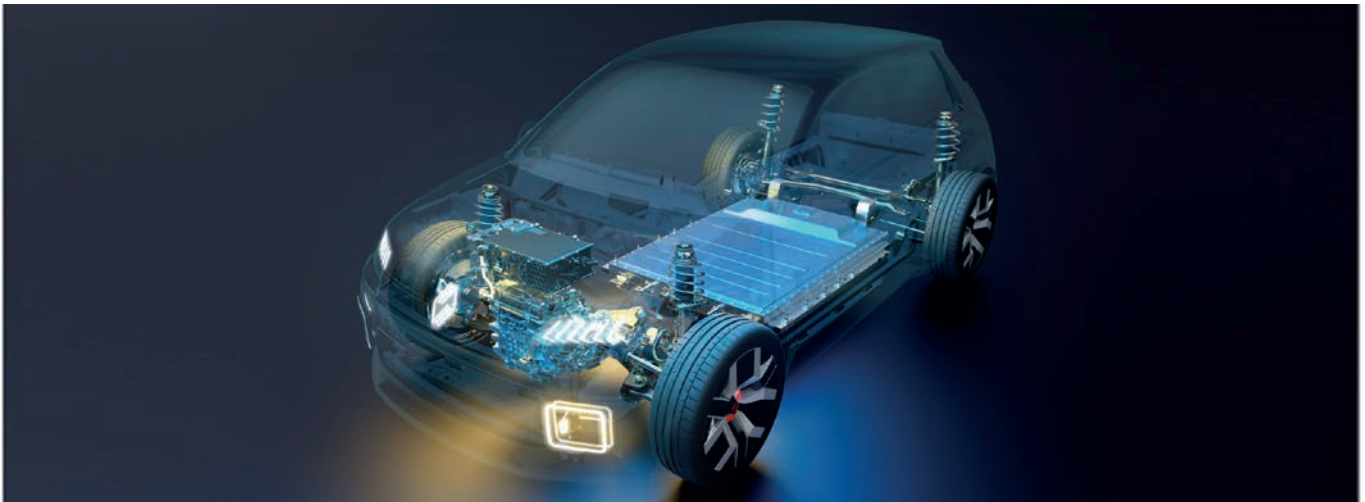
from a Kia EV3, and are somewhat typical of BEV front end repair... the chassis leg end plate can be repaired, but not other sections. So, there are two large assemblies:

1. Inner chassis leg with splayed brace for the lower front bulkhead.
2. Outer front chassis leg with strut tower and upper longitudinal.



Similarly at the rear, due to the frequent possibility of an electric motor with integrated power controller driving the rear wheels, the rear chassis leg section may not be offered.

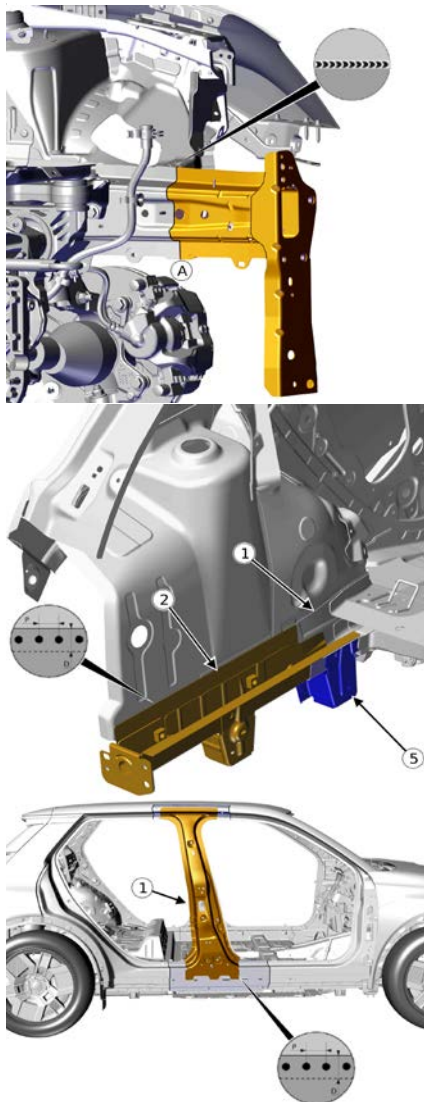
Fewer major sub-assemblies during the vehicle build, but more work to repair in the event of damage.



THE FIGHT BACK

Ampere, part of Renault Group, launched the AmpR Small platform which is now used for Renault 5 and Renault 4 E-Tech Electric. Dedicated to BEV, it sought to have a clean sheet approach to whole life cycle costing.

As we can see, the front and rear chassis leg sections are possible, as well as major repairs such as the B pillar.



WHAT ARE THE IMPLICATIONS OF A BUDGET BEV?

A smaller vehicle does not mean a smaller budget to create it given organisations such as Euro NCAP demand a level of functionality which gives no 'escape'. Making a decent profit is harder, since consumers have been brought up with the idea smaller means less expensive.

To improve profitability requires using fewer parts per vehicle, and in turn carefully managing the tooling investment to drive additional functionality to those same parts. This is very hard to do, and many manufacturers all over the world have tried to do this for a very long time.

The next generation Twingo will use an "of this evolution" platform, with fewer parts.... So what could happen to repairability? In other words, the build and assembly costs are taken care of, the vehicle is sold to customers who just might find it's rather complicated to repair due to the simplified build process.

Assuming the build and repair equation can be balanced, what is to stop other manufacturers simply copying it? Very little.

Yet the assembly cost is where the biggest change could happen, via the fewer parts increased functionality and assembly line automation – much as framing bodyshells was revolutionised years ago. The problem is as fast as the European manufacturers innovate, the well-known competition seem to get hold of the same ideas and make them via a slightly lower cost base, maintaining their commercial advantage.

Could this be a downwards spiral?

CHINA STRENGTHS AND WEAKNESSES

The China automotive sector is an overnight success which was 40 years in the making. Through multiple collaborations the sector has learnt a lot about fit / finish, while both central as well as a region government are prepared to subsidise exports too.

The weakness is around launching too many brands with too many overlapping products leading to mass confusion, and in the short term, negative effects on residuals. A further weakness demonstrated multiple times in the Middle East as well as across Africa, is product support. Compare the approach of SAIC (MG Motor / Maxus) to other brands – they have much to learn from SAIC as well as Geely (Polestar / Volvo Car).

The major issue is to prevent the single use vehicle.

It matters little if this is driven by Europe or China, it is in nobody's interests to end up in this situation. Vehicle valuation – BEV depreciation is not fully understood yet – needs recalibration to ensure there is enough retained value for repair. ADAS / SAE autonomy Level 3 and above will not eliminate collision repair for some time to come.

The process to single use vehicles is speeding up.

Massive changes vehicle manufacturers have undertaken may not be reflected in the world of vehicle valuations. Unchecked, this could cause immense damage to insurers, assessors and the collision repair business. 



AI AND THE MODERN ENGINEER ASSESSOR

The IAEA was pleased to take part in a new feature from Modern Insurance Magazine called "Associations Assemble". Joining leaders from The Credit Hire Association (CHO), the Motor Accident Solicitors Society (MASS), Managing General Agents' Association (MGAA), the British Insurance Brokers' Association (BIBA) and the Forum of Insurance Lawyers (FOIL), David Punter, President, the IAEA, shared his views on changes in the motor engineering industry.

Being a public facing entity designed to promote the professionalism of its members, highlighting the current complexities of repair in the field, and the core responsibilities to define safe outcomes for both repair and disposal following loss, the IAEA are reviewing and defining what the modern engineer assessor needs to be to deliver to be of both benefit and control.

This means further enhancing our training, development and indeed career path development to give market leading support to the community and removing the barriers to adoption for core competencies required to deliver the modern services.

These are the challenges we face, as it is all too clear that whilst AI is a clear way to automate good practices and enhance human capabilities, good practices are often talked about widely but never tested and delivered, which can make for a disappointing outcome from engineering as a whole in the industry.

AI will move decisioning dramatically over the next few years, and machine learning will benefit many, but as the old adage states "Garbage in, Garbage out," and this is the key point we need to bolster for the future to ensure compliant engineering, which is backed by core competencies and skilled technicians are the bedrock for the learning to grow properly.

This approach gives an ethical,

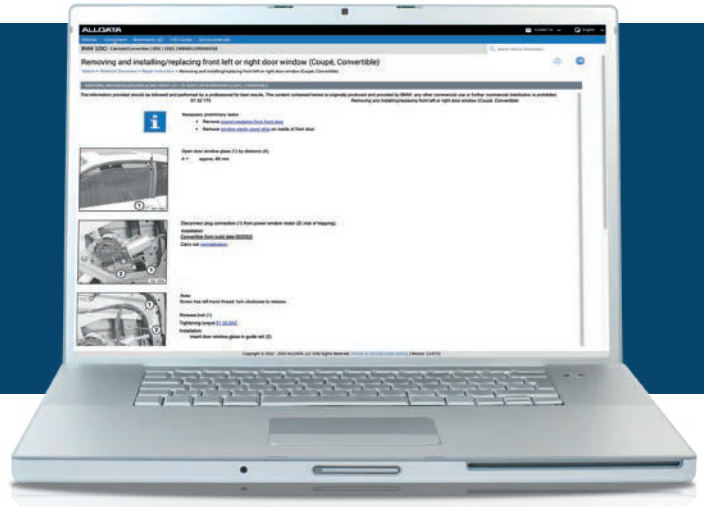
independent, verified and trusted outcome which systems can be built upon to ensure that we never lose focus of what the task is all about.

Will the IAEA ever move into AI systems being delivered for, and by its members? Well don't be surprised if you begin to see some signs of change stemming out from our core research to deliver a strong baseline for skilled recognised and qualified specialists, moving to training and education / verification backed by AI and machine learning moving ahead.

To read the views of the other industry associations head to moderninsurancemagazine.co.uk/the-magazine/

ALLDATA EUROPE: UNLOCK THE FUTURE OF SAFE AND COMPLIANT REPAIRS WITH OE REPAIR DATA

Ensuring that every vehicle is repaired to the correct standard, safely, and in compliance with regulations is essential. With the pressure on, can bodyshops afford to not invest in OE data?



As vehicles grow in complexity, particularly with the rise of Advanced Driver Assistance Systems (ADAS), bodyshops increasingly depend on Original Equipment (OE) data to perform compliant, high-quality repairs.

That is where **ALLDATA** Europe comes in – the leading provider of OE repair, maintenance and diagnostic data. By gaining direct access to OEM-sourced information on **ALLDATA** Repair, bodyshop professionals can confidently meet manufacturer standards and restore vehicles exactly to specification. More than just best practice, using **ALLDATA**'s OE data will maintain vehicle safety, protect warranty validity and build trust with both customers and work providers.

Modern vehicles rely heavily on systems like radar, lidar, and sensors – often hidden in places like bumpers or grilles. A seemingly straightforward bumper repair could have a significant impact on the vehicle's ADAS functionality. By utilizing **ALLDATA** Repair, a technician will know to recalibrate a radar sensor, preserving the vehicle's performance — and the driver's safety.

OE data helps remove the guesswork: from structural alignments to complex ADAS recalibrations, it gives repair professionals the confidence and tools they need to address the full spectrum of today's vehicle demands.

MORE THAN A RECOMMENDATION

On many modern vehicles, pre- and post-repair scans are a requirement, not an advisory. These checks help identify hidden faults in electronic systems before the vehicle returns to the road. Admittedly, they may add a time and cost – but when it comes to safety and compliance, they're non-negotiable.

By using **ALLDATA**'s OE data, technicians ensure every sensor, radar and electrical component is functioning properly, helping them deliver not just a repaired car, but a roadworthy vehicle the customer can trust.

NOW IS THE TIME TO INVEST – AND ENJOY THE BENEFITS

With ADAS systems becoming the norm, bodyshops must invest in both the right equipment and the right data solutions to remain competitive. Reassuringly, the return on investment is faster than many expect. By combining high-quality ADAS equipment with **ALLDATA**'s up-to-date OE information, bodyshops can reduce job rejections, increase throughput and cut key-to-key times.

The result is higher customer satisfaction, stronger partnerships and a noticeable boost in revenue.

ALLDATA REPAIR PROVIDES A GATEWAY TO OE DATA

ALLDATA Repair is an invaluable companion with 90 million technical articles, 8.5 million technical drawings and wiring diagrams from 43 VMs and 97% of the car parc. It provides vital, detailed insights and methods for both body and mechanical repairs, along with detailed frame dimensions and geometry data.

By utilizing the OE data available, bodyshops can assure work providers and customers alike that repairs meet the highest standards of quality and safety.

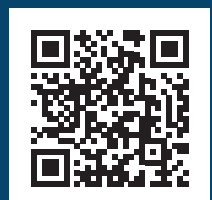
Subscribers to **ALLDATA** Repair can also benefit from the **ALLDATA** Info Centre Service. They can use this service when they need assistance to complete their repair – from exterior repair to chassis alignment and panel gaps – but when would they require support?

- Help finding specific information that hasn't been uploaded to **ALLDATA** Repair yet
- Looking for tailored service and maintenance schedules for vehicles
- Perhaps unfamiliar with a VM's repair instructions

About ALLDATA

ALLDATA is the automotive industry's #1 choice for unedited OEM repair and collision information, diagnostics, shop management software, and support services. Founded in 1986 and acquired by AutoZone in 1996, **ALLDATA** is headquartered in Elk Grove, Calif., with operations in Europe, the UK, Canada, and Mexico.

ALLDATA Europe GmbH was established in 2009 to provide automotive repair shops with accurate and unedited OE manufacturer repair data not previously available in Europe. **ALLDATA** launched **ALLDATA** Repair for the European market at Automechanika in 2012. Headquartered in Cologne, Germany, **ALLDATA** Europe GmbH has customers in more than 30 countries. **ALLDATA** sells direct and through a network of resellers and distributors throughout Europe. **ALLDATA** Repair helps workshops and garages increase productivity and accuracy while maintaining the highest-level repair standards. **ALLDATA** Europe is an affiliate of **ALLDATA** LLC.



For more information visit:
www.ALLDATA.com

VACANCIES ROUND-UP

A look at some of the latest vacancies from across the motor engineering and bodyshop vehicle damage appraisal (VDA) sectors. Please email editor@theiaea.org if you would like to include your vacancies in the next issue of The Assessors Journal.



MOTOR INSPECTIONS

JOB TITLE: Desktop Motor Engineer

DETAILS: Remote, £40,000 + per year (performance related pay scheme enhancement).

JOB SPEC: Are you an experienced Motor Engineer wanting to expand their skillset with new technologies in a new vibrant company?

Motor Inspections deal with all aspects of both insured and third-party motor inspections, using state-of-the-art technologies to receive and audit estimates prior to authorising repairs to the Approved Repairer Network as well as Customer Nominated Repairers in a timely and cost-effective manner, along with dealing with total loss settlement under the correct code of practice.

You will be in constant contact with approved repairers monitoring the performance, recognising potential areas of improvement and relationship building, and delivering excellent standards to drive great outcomes for customers.

This is a remote position, with travel into the office as and when required by arrangement.

- Member of either IMI / IRTE / IAEA or be working towards (or willing to do so).
- Current IMI VDA certification and IAEA AQP is advantageous.
- Motor claims knowledge including a basic understanding of insurance principles.
- Good working knowledge of computerised damage estimating systems, including Audatex, Glass's Repair Estimate and GT Global.
- Good spoken and written communication skills.
- Accuracy and attention to detail.
- Positive and self-confident approach when dealing with customers.
- Empathy, tact, assertiveness and diplomacy when talking to customers.
- Ability to work well under pressure, meet deadlines and where required be able to use own initiative.
- PC literate with good administrative skills.
- Ability to take on increased ownership and responsibility when necessary.

For more information, please contact:
info@motorinspections.co.uk



SOLUS

JOB TITLE: Motor Engineer

DETAILS: Remote. £35,000 - £55,000 a year – permanent, full-time.

JOB SPEC: Are you an experienced and knowledgeable Motor Engineer who would like to contribute to the Solus Aviva family?

Solus Aviva Motor Engineers preserve consistency and the very best customer service across our market leading business and our strategic partners. The world class insurance business requires a knowledgeable and skilled engineer to take claims to the next level of customer service and customer expectations.

The Engineering team deal with all aspects of both insured and third-party motor inspections, using state-of-the-art technology to receive and audit estimates prior to authorising repairs to the Approved Repairer Network as well as Customer Nominated Repairers in a timely and cost effective manner.

You will be in constant contact with Solus sites as well as approved repairers monitoring the performance, recognising potential areas of improvement and relationship building.

- Member of either IMI / IRTE / ATA / VDA or be working towards (or willing to do so).
- Motor Claims knowledge including a basic understanding of insurance principles.
- Good working knowledge of computerised damage estimating systems, including Audatex.
- Good spoken and written communication skills.
- Accuracy and attention to detail.
- Positive and self-confident approach when dealing with our customers.
- Empathy, tact, assertiveness and diplomacy when talking to customers.
- Ability to work well under pressure, meet deadlines and where required be able to use own initiative.
- PC literate with good administrative skills.
- Ability to take on increased ownership and responsibility when necessary.

SEARCH: [Solus careers](#)



AGEAS

JOB TITLE: Future Opportunity – Desk Motor Engineer

DETAILS: Permanent, part time, full time, job share option available. Salary Range: £31,200 - £46,800 dependant on experience. Location: Eastleigh, Gloucester or Bournemouth – Hybrid.

JOB SPEC: Are you an experienced motor engineer looking for your next challenge? Or perhaps you're ready to take your technical expertise into a desk-based role? While Ageas is not actively hiring for this position right now, the insurer will be looking for individuals to join the Vehicle Damage Team later this year.

By registering your interest today, you'll be the first to hear when new Desk Motor Engineer roles become available.

- Conducting remote desktop inspections to assess vehicle damage and ensure safe, cost-effective repairs.
- Providing fast, accurate technical advice to claims teams.
- Auditing repair networks and suppliers to maintain high standards.
- Supporting liability decisions and investigating potential fraud.
- Assisting with complaint resolution in line with FCA standards.
- Strong knowledge of motor vehicles, repair techniques, and estimating methods.
- Clear communication skills – able to explain technical details without jargon.
- Analytical mindset with strong decision-making and numerical skills.
- Self-motivated, proactive, and adaptable.
- Basic understanding of insurance principles.
- IAEA membership (or working towards it) is desirable.

SEARCH: [Ageas careers](#)



FYLDE COAST ARC

JOB TITLE: Experienced Vehicle Damage Assessor (VDA)

DETAILS: OTE VDA position £49,920. Full-time position. Location: Fylde Coast ARC FY4 2RP.

JOB SPEC: As a Vehicle Damage Assessor, you will be responsible for inspecting damaged vehicles, assessing repairs, and providing accurate reports to ensure that each vehicle is restored to its best condition. ATA accreditation preferred.

- Previous experience in vehicle damage assessment (preferred).
- Knowledge of vehicle repair processes.
- Excellent attention to detail.
- Strong communication skills.
- A full UK driving license.

Apply now by sending your CV to
dane@arcblackpool.co.uk
or call directly 07540 125635

[continued on page 24]

Motability Operations

MOTABILITY OPERATIONS

JOB TITLE: Vehicle Inspector

DETAILS: Coalville, hybrid (work remotely up to two days per week), full time.

JOB SPEC: Motability Operations are currently recruiting for a Vehicle Inspector to join the team in Coalville on a full-time, permanent basis. You will join a team of dedicated

Inspectors to carry out the initial assessment on vehicles. This role reports into the Inspection Supervisor. As Vehicle Inspector you will inspect vehicles and assess any damage sustained, as per Motability Inspection Standard specification and reporting criteria, identifying the cost and time scales for repair.

Key responsibilities: inspect vehicles, record details accurately and fully assess the extent of any sustained damage, having a keen eye for detail and in line with Motability Inspection Standards specification. Identify the correct repair methods. Ability to work to deadlines and targets and strong organisational and multi-tasking skills. To respond proactively to site and KPI targets. Use bespoke inspection software (training will be provided).



FORAY MOTOR GROUP

JOB TITLE: Vehicle Damage Assessor

DETAILS: Andover, full time.

JOB SPEC: Are you a skilled Vehicle Damage Assessor looking for more than just a job? Key responsibilities include:

Essential skills and behaviours

- Experience in estimating within an accident repair environment.
- Proficiency in Audatex, GT Motive, and image-supported estimating.
- Working knowledge of Thatcham repair methods and BS10125 processes.
- Strong communication skills – with both customers and insurers.
- NVQ/IMI or ATA VDA qualification (preferred but not essential).
- Proactive attitude and ability to mentor or support junior staff.

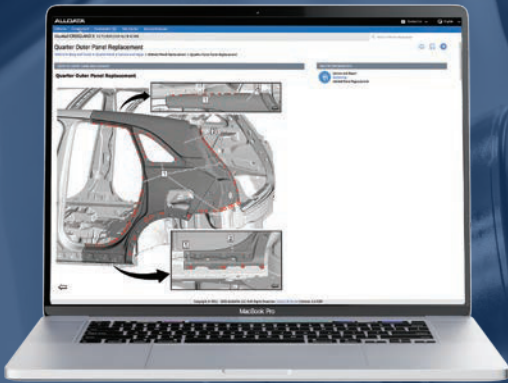
ALLDATA[®]

AUTOMOTIVE INTELLIGENCE[®]

SIMPLIFY REPAIRS, MAXIMISE PROFIT

Your go-to official source for OEM body repair data

ALLDATA REPAIR empowers bodyshops with **24/7 access** to OEM repair data from **43 vehicle manufacturers**, covering **97% of cars** on the road, ensuring conformity with manufacturer methods



CLAIM YOUR FREE 14-DAY TRIAL HERE!

ALLDATA: YOUR KEY TO COMPLIANCE AND QUALITY CONTROL IN A COMPLEX REPAIR ENVIRONMENT



RECALL CAMPAIGN TAKATA AIRBAG

TAKATA AIRBAGS: Stellantis, the parent company of Citroën, has recalled tens of thousands of Citroën and DS models in the UK due to faulty airbags that, in some circumstances, can explode in an uncontrolled manner, causing injury or even death.

Stellantis UK announced an immediate stop-drive action for all Citroën C3 (second generation) and DS 3 (first generation) vehicles manufactured between 2009 and 2019 equipped with Takata airbags. Owners of such vehicles should immediately cease using their vehicle when safe to do so, said the VM.

The affected models are:

- **Citroën C3 (manufactured from 2009 to 2016)**
- **Citroën DS3 (manufactured from 2009 to 2016)**
- **DS Automobiles DS3 (manufactured from 2016 to 2019)**

Vehicles included in this new stop-drive action in the UK were already part of an ongoing comprehensive recall campaign that started over one year ago, first in Southern Europe and then expanded northwards. Recall decisions, especially stop-drive actions, are based on multiple factors, including airbag specifications, vehicle age and usage, climate conditions, and notifications from regulatory authorities.

Whilst there have been no reported instances in the UK, Stellantis has decided to deploy a stop-drive order for all impacted vehicles across Europe including the UK.

"This decision underscores the Company's unwavering commitment to customer safety," said Stellantis.

The broader Takata airbag crisis – as previously reported by The Assessors Journal – has led to recalls of tens of millions of vehicles worldwide from numerous manufacturers.

Approximately 67 million Takata air bags (priority groups 1-12) have been recalled because these air bags can explode when deployed, causing serious injury or even death, said the US-based National Highway Traffic Safety Administration (NHTSA).

While the risk was previously considered low in the UK due to the country's milder climate, the seriousness of the fault prompted action following at least 18 deaths in France – including 16 in its hotter overseas territories – all associated with Takata airbags, it is reported.

Stellantis said all affected customers will be notified by letter. Customers can also check if their vehicle is affected and what actions are advised by using the VIN (Vehicle Identification Number) check tool on the Citroën UK website. If impacted, owners are advised to register their vehicle to enable the processing of their repair as soon as possible.

A statement from Stellantis reads:

"It is of paramount importance that

owners of vehicles who may have changed either their address or contact details keep their information updated with the DVLA (Driver & Vehicle Licensing Authority) so that they can be reached in a timely and efficient manner.

"Stellantis UK is mobilising its full network of suppliers, retailers and manufacturing plant to support this action and ensure the fastest, safest and most convenient solution for each customer.

"Stellantis remains fully committed to acting swiftly, transparently, and responsibly in addressing this issue."

Consumer group, Which?, asked the Association of British Insurers (ABI) what insurance companies can do to assist.

The ABI said: "in general, recalls don't usually result in insurance claims, which are typically reserved for accidents or other incidents (such as a tree falling on your car). The same applies to courtesy cars: they're supplied for cars with accident damage.

"The body also stated that it was important to follow the manufacturer's instructions and to check with your insurer if you have any questions about driving a car involved in a recall, as failing to do so could invalidate your insurance policy," said Which? 



INSIDE THE WORLD'S BIGGEST CRASH TEST

Cranfield University and Channel 4 stage a groundbreaking motorway pile-up.

Eight cars, 94 cameras, a 30-ton HGV, hundreds of hours of planning and preparation, and a team of drivers with no idea what's about to happen... Pile Up – The World's Biggest Crash Test is the most ambitious experiment of its kind.

Produced by Blink Films for Channel 4, the programme heavily involved experts from Cranfield University, who helped the team construct the scenario and examine what happens to cars in a real-life motorway pile up.

Multi-vehicle accidents are poorly understood, and questions about vehicle safety, driver behaviour, and crash dynamics remain largely unanswered because researchers only ever arrive post-crash. This experiment will allow experts to understand how safety systems fare, how drivers react and why some people survive while others don't.

Professor of Automotive Engineering at Cranfield University, James Brighton, and his team from the Advanced Vehicle Engineering Centre worked closely with the production team to design a high-speed multi-vehicle pile up. Expertise from the Cranfield Impact Centre was brought in to gather highly detailed crash data, with motorsport crash data recorders installed in each car's internal structure.

Professor Brighton said: "Creating a high-speed motorway crash really was a unique challenge and there could be no second takes. There was a lot at stake, and we had to plan meticulously to get it right first time. It was a fascinating opportunity to look at a real-world crash scenario and get very detailed data from driver reactions to the events unfolding before them. That's something we will now feed into our teaching materials across all our Automotive and Motorsport MSc

courses and especially our new MSc in Virtual Prototyping so that students taking our courses can help develop even safer and more efficient cars in the future."

THE EXPERIMENT



In the west coast of Scotland, a former RAF base with a taxiway almost two miles long is transformed into a stretch of motorway, with white lines, a hard shoulder, and motorway-grade

varioguard barriers designed to contain the crash.

Professor James Brighton and his team create a high-speed multi-vehicle crash involving eight different vehicles and 30-ton HGV coming into their lane head on.

The range of vehicles that will be driven at motorway speeds each have a different size, weight, wheelbase, and engine layout, that will take part in the pile up include:

- A pioneer of the hybrid era, 2012 Toyota Prius
- A convertible, a mid-engine Porsche Boxster series 1
- A high-performance hatchback, a Volkswagen Golf GTI from 2009
- A pick-up truck, and a US favourite – the Ford F-150
- An Executive Saloon car, the Audi A8
- A people carrier, the 8 seat Dodge Grand Caravan
- A sport utility vehicle, the Mercedes ML
- And no motorway scene would be complete without a white van... in this case a Vauxhall Vivaro.

To stage such an incident and keep everyone safe requires cutting-edge immersive remote-control driving technology. Track cars are controlled from remote 'pods'.

Four members of the public, selected to represent a cross-section of road users, join four of James Brighton's team, each controlling real cars via the pods. As they drive as a pack at motorway speeds, a lorry driving the opposite direction swerves across the central reservation into their lanes. A pile up is inevitable.

Over 90 cameras, go-pros and drones capture the resulting crash. Black boxes fixed to the track cars record vehicle data and driver responses. Cameras record the drivers' reactions. Not one car is left unscathed after the crash. Some are barely recognisable. But who would have survived the crash and why?

US crash analysis expert, Dr Janet Bahouth will evaluate how the cars and their safety systems perform, she said: "My main interest will be looking at the damage of the vehicle and to see how that influenced the survivability of the crash and learn from that so that tomorrow somebody

else can benefit from it. Automotive manufacturers would love to be able to design against multiple impacts for one vehicle. It's difficult, though, because you can't have an airbag deploy twice. The seatbelt in conjunction with the airbag is really the best combination. And then from there, the safety structures of the vehicle, keeping the occupant compartment intact."

The final part of the experiment tests crash investigators. Marcus Rowe, a crash investigator, is let loose on the scene. His job, having not witnessed the crash, is to figure out what happened using crash forensics. This experiment will reveal how accurate current accident analysis really is, and how it can be improved to make roads safer for all of us.

THE PUBLIC



To make the pile up as realistic as possible, and to capture genuine reactions, the four selected drivers will be members of the public who have no knowledge of the true nature of the experiment. All four believe they are taking part in an experiment to improve motorway safety and advance their driving. They are unaware that they will soon be involved in a high speed multi car pile-up.

They are:

Caitlyn, 19, health care assistant from Liverpool

Luke, 26, construction worker from Brighton

Lynn, 66, grandmother from Rochdale

Tito, 57, surfer, originally from San Diego and now lives in Glasgow.

THE FINDINGS

While all experts recognise this is a one-off experiment, the crash threw up interesting results:

Crash forensic investigation is highly accurate. The team managed to pinpoint extraordinary details about

the crash, including a freak one in a million occurrence of one car careering under the lorry.

Crumple zones work – despite a massive rear shunt from a white van, the Prius electric battery remained intact thanks to crumple zones. Others' lives were saved by them.

Air bags might not deploy depending on where the vehicle is hit, leading to disastrous consequences.

Safety systems struggle with multiple impacts – crumple zones and airbags in the Dodge did little after the first or second impact.

A panicked driver isn't rational – despite coming to a stop safely, one of the drivers then accelerated into the lorry.

High driving position enables earlier response to events ahead – as shown by the measured braking of the utility vehicle.

The hard shoulder is a dangerous place to be – any drivers or passengers in the cars on our hard shoulder would most likely have lost their lives.



Head to **@Channel4Documentaries** on YouTube to watch a short video clip and find the full report via: **channel4.com/programmes/pile-up-worlds-biggest-crash-test**

FAST FACTS

- In 2020, nearly 20% of all motorists killed in the UK died in crashes involving three or more vehicles...also known as a pile up
- Someone is killed or injured on British roads every 17 minutes
- Almost 75,000 car users were injured on UK roads in 2022, and nearly 800 car occupants died
- 45% of UK drivers exceed the speed limit on British motorways and 24% of fatal crashes involve speeding drivers
- 24% of drivers who die on British roads aren't wearing seatbelts.



ALLIANZ CONTINUES EXPANSION INTO THE UK

As Allianz's steady rise as one of the UK's leading insurance brands continues, we talk to Michael Golding, Allianz Motor Network Manager and Jessica Archbold, Allianz Network Delivery Manager, about network performance, apprenticeships, repair volumes and Allianz's research into the actual environmental benefits of repair over replace.

Allianz has been named one of the 30 most valuable brands in the world, moving up two places to the 29th position in this year's Best Global Brands ranking from Interbrand. The global insurer with 125 million customers and 157,000 employees has been recognised as the most valuable financial services brand for the sixth consecutive time.

In addition, thanks to its flexible working model, wide range of benefits and development opportunities and commitment to diversity and inclusion, Allianz was recognised for its strong employer brand and ranked seventh in the Fortune 100 Best Companies to Work for in Europe 2024.

Allianz has also made changes to its claims operation combining the commercial and personal lines teams to create a single function. Led by Matt Cox, Chief Claims Officer at Allianz, he explained that bringing these two

teams together will more effectively drive the continued development of activities performed by front line claims handlers and operations teams, enabling them to continue to provide a top-class service to customers.

“

The performance of the repair network is closely monitored and graded into 'performing', 'outperforming' or 'underperforming'.

”

Recently, Allianz UK has contributed to a research project, in association with the Vehicle Recyclers Association (VRA), its salvage partner SYNETIQ

and Oakdene Hollins, about the influence of vehicle repair techniques on greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions. The 'Repair or Replace?' study investigated the carbon footprint of repairing or replacing damaged vehicle parts and compared the upstream and downstream logistics for each operation including collection of a donor vehicle, dismantling parts, to delivery to a bodyshop as well as the CO₂ associated for painting and curing a reclaimed part. The project also calculated and compared the equivalent GHG for a new, manufactured part to be fitted.

In its conclusion the study highlighted that repairing a part is the optimal choice, but if repair is no longer viable for technical and/or economic reasons, the use of green parts is preferable over replacing with new original parts.

"I am now working with the authors of the paper and working with our global colleagues to share best practice and encourage innovation," said Michael

Golding, Motor Network Manager. Michael has helped establish new ESG (Environmental, Social and Governance) standards governing environmental repair of electric vehicles and staff wellbeing that 50% of the approved repair network have so far achieved.

The PAS 2060 element of the standards will be replaced with the new environmental standard ARIES (Accident Repair Industry Environmental Standard). Allianz has been part of the steering group that has created the improved standard that is more relevant to the body repair industry (see our article on page 19). The insurer is doing a lot of work with its network on electric vehicle repair too.

"Although our EV exposure is still small, it is growing and what we want is to be able to repair electric vehicles in our network," said Michael. "It is important to understand where the EV claims are and making sure that we have a standard, so when we are asked to repair an EV, we can with confidence say that we can. It is vital that technicians are getting the training, the tooling and are qualified to complete those repairs.

"We have also been working with Thatcham Research on battery repairs and our salvage agent SYNETIQ on what they are doing with batteries in the result of a total loss," added Michael. "It is that whole circular economy of sustainability that we want to be able to achieve and be at the forefront."

Michael is a trustee of AutoRaise and apprenticeships continue to be important. Allianz UK is funding 25 apprentices, four of whom have passed their End Point Assessment (EPA). "I have tracked every one of them from the date they enrolled, which college

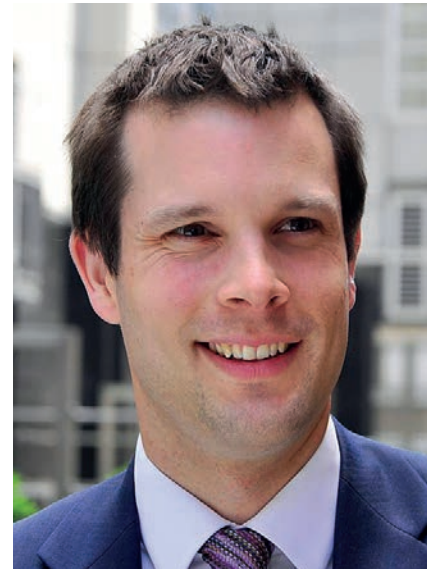
they went to etc, and out of the 25 apprentices who started two-and-a-half years ago, we have only lost six," said Michael. "I am proud of that figure because a lot of apprentices drop out half-way, but most of ours have continued. Even if you employed 25 people, after two years you would probably lose more than six."

The performance of the repair network is closely monitored and graded into 'performing', 'outperforming' or 'underperforming'. "Sixty-seven percent of the network are in our outperforming categories," said Michael.

"We operate a labour rate matrix to reward performance, which was increased in March this year, and we put a lot of effort into the ones who are in the performing or underperforming categories to help them improve and become more profitable," he explained. "We support repairers with monthly statistics and discuss with them any missed profit opportunities. We also offer training in repair over replace through a couple of companies we utilise."

The latest figures from last winter to the current time show that Allianz has been able to maintain a strong performance in its network. "Our customer service level has gone well," continued Michael. "We are now at 93% for CSI, which is incredibly pleasing. Our network conversion rate also remains as strong as ever which shows we have good control of the repairs within the network."

Jessica Archbold, Allianz Network Delivery Manager, added: "As a result of the amazing work that Michael and his team have been doing on sustainability, and because Allianz is a global company, other countries within the Allianz group are coming to Michael to find out



how he has developed the standards and are interested to know how we operate with the repair network as a partnership."

Work volumes are often cited as having declined 20% in the last two years but Michael thinks that the comparison to volumes in 2022/23 is not a true measurement. "When we were coming out of the Covid lockdowns, the world went a little bit mad and there was around 10-15% overcapacity," he said. "A more accurate way to benchmark volumes is comparing current with 2019/20 figures, which would show volumes are around 10% down."

Allianz is doing a lot of analysis looking at customer trends. "We are working with our network, especially around consumer duty awareness, communication and updating customers," said Michael. "I have to say that has really improved, helped by some of the data driven systems that they are all beginning to adopt. What we are trying to do with our network is to run the very best, and we are achieving that."





INSURANCE M&A

ACTIVITY HOTS UP

Direct Line Insurance Group was acquired by Aviva on 1 July 2025 in a £3.7 billion “mega-merger” deal, giving the newly combined business around 21% share of the total UK motor insurance market (2024 figures, via ABP Club).

Here, David Cresswell, Chairman at ABP Club, comments on the most recent in a series of merger and acquisition (M&A) activity in the motor insurance market.

Early results from ABP’s research for the 2026 ABP Industry Yearbook reveals how dominant the newly combined Aviva/Direct Line business will be in the UK motor insurance market.

ABP’s exclusive analysis of the insurance companies 2024 SFCRs (Solvency and Financial Condition Reports) reveals that the combined Aviva/Direct Line business had around a 21% share of the total UK motor insurance market in 2024.

The analysis also reveals that the soon-to-be-expanded Ageas Group will become the third largest UK motor insurer: Ageas’ acquisition of Acromas completed on 1 July 2025 and the acquisition of esure, announced in April 2025, is expected to complete in H2 2025.

Top 10 UK motor insurers in 2024 (gross written UK motor premium):

1. Aviva and Direct Line (combined): £5,804 million
2. Admiral Group: £4,007 million
3. Ageas and esure and Acromas (combined) £2,374 million
4. Allianz Group (inc LV=): £2,156 million
5. Hastings Group: £1,724 million
6. RSA Group: £1,170 million
7. Axa: £1,124 million
8. Great Lakes Insurance UK (sold through MGAs): £979 million
9. NFU: £873 million
10. First Central: £742 million.

These top 10 motor insurers wrote around 75% of all motor insurance in the UK in 2024, said David.

Speaking as the Aviva and Direct Line deal was cleared by the Competition and Markets Authority (CMA), Amanda Blanc, Group Chief Executive Officer, Aviva, said:

“The completion of the acquisition of Direct Line brings together some of the country’s best-known and admired insurance brands and brilliant people

to better serve the needs of now 20 million UK customers. The transaction builds on the excellent progress we’ve made at Aviva over the last five years, accelerates our capital-light growth strategy, and puts us in a very good position to deliver strong returns for shareholders. That is why this deal made such sense for us and we are excited at the further opportunities this creates for Aviva’s growth.”

Jason Storah, previously CEO of UK & Ireland General Insurance at Aviva, has been appointed as CEO for the combined businesses.

“By combining the strengths of both organisations, we’ll be able to offer more to our customers and create value for our shareholders,” said Jason. “It’s a step that makes sense for the long term – commercially, strategically, and culturally.

Owen Morris has been named CEO of UK personal lines, with responsibility for both the Direct Line and Aviva personal lines businesses. He will report directly to Jason.

Several interim leadership appointments have also been made within the Direct Line business, including Michael Korner as motor managing director. 

DATA DRIVEN DECISIONS

Solera Audatex saw £1.7 million in new data sales (FY25) reflecting growing market demand for data. With Solera Audatex providing IAEA Members with access to the CAP valuation guides (more on this in news), The Assessors Journal caught up with Sales Director, Tom Hart, for an update on what has been a busy year-to-date for Solera Audatex, with 278 new repairers joining the Audatex network, 57 new vehicle models and 285 updates added across platforms, and 17 new parts suppliers integrated.



Data analytics, artificial intelligence (AI), and repair performance metrics: the team at Solera Audatex has been rapid in its response to some of the ever-evolving environmental and customer-driven trends that many repairers in the bodyshop market are grappling with in 2025.

There's a suite of solutions to directly address what's happening "now and next," Tom Hart, Sales Director for Audatex UK said. Plus, a bolstered Solera Audatex Crash Repair Team (CRT) to support bodyshop clients with fluctuating claims volumes, new vehicle tech and pressure on margins.

Audatex UK provides 99.3% coverage of passenger and LCV models (up to 10-years-old) and 98.8% EV coverage, covering more than 700,000 vehicles.

In today's fast-paced repair industry, staying competitive means more than just fixing cars – it means making data-driven decisions that optimise every job, every quote, and every resource, outlined Tom. Solera Analytics for Repairers, available via Audatex UK, is an "all-in-one analytics solution purpose-built for vehicle repairers".

"From real-time performance tracking to market benchmarking, this platform empowers you to make smarter decisions, faster," said Tom.

OPERATIONAL INSIGHTS

This allows instant visibility into key "metrics that matter", he explained, including claims volume, repairability index, job severity, and cost variances. Users can customise filters by claim, insurer, vehicle info, or shop, and "dive deep" into your own data – or

market-wide data: useful for single-site and group bodyshops, according to Tom.

Repairers can generate custom dashboards and reports, and save, schedule and share reports using fixed or dynamic dates.

BENCHMARKING

Bodyshops can benchmark their business against competitors using anonymised industry data, track costs and labour by variant and paint level, and even see a breakdown of parts costs by OEM, section, or volume, to expedite "negotiation opportunities with suppliers", said Tom.

"The repairability metrics mean bodyshops can understand how your repairability index impacts margins," said Tom, "by part, make, and model" via an Add-On Insights option.

Solera Analytics for Repairers allows repair professionals to "collaborate with confidence using a platform built for real repairers doing real work," said Tom, using a secure, scalable, and user-friendly format that helps bodyshops "make smarter decisions".

Smart solutions are in demand right now with margins under pressure and, Tom said: "The automotive repair industry stands at the threshold of a revolution driven by AI, and those who adapt quickly will lead the way." He explained that repairing vehicles today requires more than a deep understanding of mechanical components; it also demands expertise in AI-powered technologies that are now integral to many vehicles. "This shift presents both opportunities and challenges for the industry, particularly as it faces a significant shortage of skilled technicians equipped to work

with these advanced systems," said Tom.

For bodyshops, this means "adapting to an evolving landscape".

Traditionally, automotive technicians honed their skills through hands-on experience with systems, Tom explained. However, as vehicles have evolved, so have the skills required to repair them. Today's vehicles often feature software-driven diagnostics, AI systems, and electric powertrains that differ significantly from internal combustion engines (ICE).

The cost of advanced training is one of the largest obstacles for small and independent repair shops. Programmes designed to teach technicians how to use AI-powered tools and advanced diagnostics often cost thousands of pounds per student, making them prohibitive for businesses operating on tight margins. Without these skills, smaller shops risk falling behind, unable to compete with larger chains that can afford to invest in staff upskilling.

Blended learning offers a practical and cost-effective solution. By combining in-person training with online courses, technicians can gain hands-on experience while leveraging virtual learning for topics such as AI diagnostics. This approach is particularly valuable for those in remote or rural areas and is where solutions like Solera's Autodata play a vital role in making training accessible. By offering on-demand access to training materials and diagnostic tools, technicians can upskill without leaving their workshops. Short training videos, step-by-step repair guides, and interactive content enable learning to fit seamlessly into a technician's workday. 



INSIDE CATERHAM CARS

A LEGACY OF LIGHTWEIGHT PRECISION AND PASSION



Nestled in Dartford, Kent, Caterham Cars continues to embody the spirit of Colin Chapman's original vision: "Simplify, then add lightness". A recent tour of their facility offered a rare glimpse into the meticulous craftsmanship, engineering philosophy, and enduring passion that define this iconic British marque, writes IAEA London Region Honorary Secretary Peter Beddow.

Since acquiring the rights to the Lotus Seven in 1973, Caterham has remained steadfast in its mission to deliver pure, unfiltered driving experiences. With models ranging from the approachable Seven 170 to the blisteringly fast 620R, every car is a celebration of minimalism and mechanical engagement. Despite evolving technologies and shifting market demands, Caterham's ethos remains unchanged: reduce weight,

increase power, and maximise driver enjoyment.

ORGANISED VISIT BY THE IAEA

The tour was organised by Peter Beddow, on behalf of the Institute of Automotive Engineer Assessors (IAEA), with 17 members and three guests in attendance.

Peter writes:

As the London Region Honorary Secretary, I had the pleasure of

coordinating the visit. The group thoroughly enjoyed the experience, from the light-hearted humour and engaging commentary of our guides, Alex and Alan, to the fascinating technical insights shared throughout the day. The Caterham technicians were exceptionally obliging, eager to discuss the intricacies of the build and technical processes, and their genuine enthusiasm for their craft shone through, leaving a lasting impression on all attendees. Special thanks also go to London Region Chairman,

Gary Hunt, whose efforts in securing funding allowed the visit to be a complimentary event for all participants.

CRAFTSMANSHIP AT THE CORE

What sets Caterham apart is its commitment to hand-built excellence. Each car is assembled by a single technician, whose name is proudly affixed to the finished vehicle. A basic model takes approximately two weeks to complete, while higher-spec variants can require up to four weeks. This approach ensures consistency, accountability, and a personal touch that mass production simply cannot replicate.

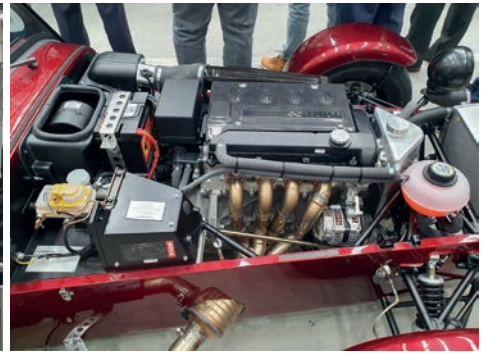
Trainees typically spend a year mastering the assembly of base models before progressing to more complex builds. This structured development pathway not only safeguards quality but also nurtures a deep understanding of the vehicle's engineering.

ENGINEERING INSIGHTS

Caterham's engineering is as thoughtful as it is thrilling. The chassis, composed of two main sections – the basket and the long front, can be repaired with precision using factory jigs, allowing damaged sections to be replaced without compromising alignment.

The engine room is climate-controlled to maintain consistent torque settings during assembly. Models such as the 360 and 420 feature upgraded pistons with modified crowns, while the 485 and 480 benefit from a Japanese roller barrel inlet manifold setup. Dry sump options are available on select models to optimise weight distribution.

Caterham is also adapting to changing powertrain landscapes. Ford hybrid engines are currently being modified back to internal combustion configurations to suit Caterham's



performance goals. Though the Ford Duratec engine will soon be phased out in favour of the Horse unit, a new 4 cylinder turbocharged 1.3 litre. Lightweight and with plenty of scope for tuning, an exciting time for Caterham.

A BALANCE OF TRADITION AND INNOVATION

Despite the availability of factory-built cars, Caterham continues to honour its roots by offering kits for self-assembly, a nod to Chapman's original vision of owner-built performance. The Westbury division fabricates the chassis and hand-forms body panels, with each side panel requiring around eight hours of preparation. Shells are delivered weekly, supporting an annual production capacity of 750 units, currently on the rise from 500 thanks to Caterham's increased production capability in the new factory.

Two dedicated paint booths ensure a flawless finish, using PPG paints to achieve a wide range of high-quality finishes, from solid colours to complex three-and four-stage pearls. This allows Caterham to offer both classic and contemporary aesthetics while maintaining the brand's commitment to craftsmanship and visual appeal.

CONCLUSION

Caterham Cars is more than a manufacturer; it is a custodian of a driving philosophy that prioritises connection, simplicity, and joy. For automotive engineers and assessors, the Dartford facility offers a masterclass in how tradition and innovation can coexist without compromise. In an era of increasing automation and digitalisation, Caterham's approach is a refreshing reminder of the power of human craftsmanship and mechanical purity.

Author: Peter Beddow A.Inst.AEA MFIEA CAE
MIMI EngTech MIMechE





FIEA TECHNICAL DAY AND AGM: POLAND, 10-11 OCTOBER 2025

The 2025 Technical Day will be held in Poznan, Poland on 10 October 2025. This will be a full day of presentations from specialists at the cutting edge of automotive technology and our profession as experts in damage assessing. In the evening there will be a gala dinner.

This will be followed, the morning after, on 11 October with the FIEA AGM. This year, elections will be taking place for officers of the Steering (Executive) Committee. They are: President, Vice President, General Secretary, General Delegate and Treasurer.

The positions are available to current Board Members (country delegates and Executive members).

The location will be at the Hotel Novotel Poznań Malta, Termalna 5, 61-028 Poznań, Poland.

Accommodation will be made available to attendees at preferential rates.

Please refer to the FIEA website (fiea.org/en/) for further information when it becomes available.

AGM Notice:

This General Assembly will be special, as it will include elections.

To ensure proper preparation for this elective General Assembly, you will find below the section of the statutes concerning candidacies, along with the timeline.

Art. 21: Applications to the steering committee:

Each list must present candidates from at least two member countries. The candidates emanate from the board of directors:

- *Candidates for the post of the president and vice president must have been directors for at least six years*
- *Candidates for the post of general secretary and treasurer must be validated by their association*
- *The general delegate must be of French nationality*

The list of candidates accompanied by the written program, must reach the general secretariat of the FIEA three months before the scheduled election date (ie 11/07/25) by registered letter, or by any other official means of communication. The secretary-general communicates the names(s) of the candidate(s) to all members.

In the case of failed election, the board of directors will ensure the functionality of the steering committee and will appoint one of its members to the function of an interim-president until the next G.A.

The steering committee may elect one

or more representatives with clearly defined mandates.

All directors are pledged to keep discussions secret and oblige to do so in their honour.

Art. 22: Term of office, re-election of the Steering Committee:

Members of the Steering Committee are elected for three years. They are re-eligible at the expiry of their mandate.

The president's term of office can be renewed only once. The representative of a country may not succeed another representative from the same country in the President-ship it is preferable for each country to take turns in presenting a candidate for the Presidentship.

In case of vacancy, the Steering Committee provides for the interim replacement of its members on the board of directors. The functions of the members so appointed shall expire at the time that would normally expire the term of the members replaced.

In case of vacancy of the President, the steering committee provides for the interim replacement. There shall be a general election at the next general meeting.

DIARY DATES

2025 | 26



If you are planning an event, you may find it useful to check with this listing to avoid any clash of dates. If you have an event this year, or indeed next year, then please email editor@theiaea.org with details and we will include it. There is no charge.

2025

3rd Sept	Cenex Expo 2025, Millbrook
3 rd Sept	Motor Transport Awards, London
3rd & 4th Sept	Vizion Kinetic 2025, Telford International Centre
9 th Sept	ABP Club Networking Golf Day, Wychwood Park, Crewe
9 th - 14 th Sept	IAA Mobility Show, Munich
11 th Sept	Insurance Post Claims Club: Fraud, London
12 th Sept	The Independent Garage Association (IGA) British Independent Garage (BIG) Awards 2025, NEC Birmingham
17 th & 18 th Sept	CARS and MRE 2025, NEC Birmingham
18th Sept	Insurance Times 2025 Tech & Innovation Awards, London
18 th Sept	NBRA Greener Bodyshop Awards 2025, Coventry
20th Sept	IAEA AGM (TBC)
23 rd Sept	Insurance Post The British Insurance Technology Awards, London
2 nd Oct	ILC Exclusive Motor Claims Conference, London
2 nd Oct	Insurance Post Claims & Fraud Awards, London
7 th Oct	Fleet & Mobility Live 2025, Birmingham
8 th Oct	ABI Motor Conference, London
9 th Oct	Insurance Post Claims Club: Claims innovation and future trends, Birmingham
9 th Oct	Insurance AI & Tech Club, Birmingham
9 th Oct	ABP Club Networking Golf Day, The Belfry Hotel & Resort, Sutton Coldfield
14 th - 18 th Oct	Equip Auto, Paris
16 th Oct	Credit Hire Organisation (CHO) Mobility in Insurance, British Motor Museum, Gaydon

16 th Oct	Credit Hire Organisation (CHO) Networking Dinner, Warwick
20th Oct	Bodyshop Awards and Expo 2025, Sutton Coldfield
29th & 30th Oct	Advanced Engineering, NEC Birmingham
4th - 5th Nov	Insurance Innovators Summit, London
4 th - 7 th Nov	SEMA Show, Las Vegas
5 th Nov	National Engineering Day, National
6 th Nov	ILC MGA Claims Conference, London
10 th - 14 th Nov	Tomorrow's Engineers Week 2025, Nationally
10 th - 21 st Nov	United Nations COP30, Baku
12 th Nov	AM live 2025, NEC Birmingham
19th Nov	VRA Automotive Summit, Warwick
19 th Nov	Motor Trader Industry Awards, London
20th Nov	ABP Club Annual Convention and Night of Knights, Manchester
25 th Nov	SMMT Annual Dinner, London
26 th - 28 th Nov	London EV Show, ExCeL London
3rd Dec	Insurance Times Awards, London

2026

16 th Jan	ILC Motor Claims Networking Lunch
5 th - 7 th Feb	Automechanika New Delhi
12 th Mar	SMMT Electrified, London
18 th Mar	Fleet News Awards, London
21st Apr	CV Show, Birmingham
6th May	ABP British Bodyshop Awards, Manchester
13 th - 14 th May	Fix Auto UK Conference, Birmingham
13 th - 14 th May	BIBA Conference, Manchester



iaea
THE INSTITUTE OF AUTOMOTIVE
ENGINEER ASSESSORS